

ABOLITIONIST AND AUTHOR (1811–96)

HARRIET BEECHER STOWE



the free states.

Harriet Beecher Stowe wrote *Uncle Tom's Cabin* at the peak of Northern resentment against the Fugitive Slave Act of 1850. First appearing in 40 installments in the anti-slavery newspaper, the *National Era*, it was published as a book by a Boston company in 1852. It would outsell all others, except the Bible, throughout the 19th century. Southerners resented its portrayal of slavery and the audacity of a Northern woman who dared condemn it. Among Northerners, many responded with tears and pity for the fictional slaves—a sympathy that many had rarely felt for those actually enslaved. The book created an emotional climate that made more Northerners receptive to anti-slavery appeals and sectional claims of the moral superiority of